[redacted]

6 DECEMBER 1943

SECRET
OPERATIONAL PRIORITY

FROM: WAR - 3982 - 060018Z

TO: ANISCA, CHUNGKING

DECLASSIFIED
By Deputy Archivist of the U.S.
By N. J. Stewart Date MAR 9 1972

PERSONAL AND [redacted] FROM THE PRESIDENT TO THE GENERALISSIMO.

CONFERENCE WITH MARSHAL STALIN INVOLVES US IN COMBINED GRAND OPERATIONS ON EUROPEAN CONTINENT IN LATE SPRING GIVING FAIR PROSPECT OF TERMINATING WAR WITH GERMANY BY END OF SUMMER 1944. THESE OPERATIONS IMPOSE SO LARGE A REQUIREMENT OF HEAVY LANDING CRAFT AS TO MAKE IT IMPRACTICABLE TO DEVOTE A SUFFICIENT NUMBER TO THE AMPHIBIOUS OPERATION IN BAY OF BENGAL SIMULTANEOUSLY WITH LAUNCHING OF THE ADVANCE ON INDAW KATHA AREA OF BURMA TO INSURE SUCCESS OF OPERATION.

THIS BEING THE CASE. WOULD YOU BE PREPARED TO GO AHEAD WITH THE INDAW KATHA OPERATION AS NOW PLANNED, INCLUDING COMMITMENT TO MAINTAIN NAVAL CONTROL OF BAY OF BENGAL COUPLED WITH NAVAL CARRIER AND COMMANDO AMPHIBIOUS RAIDING OPERATIONS SIMULTANEOUS WITH LAUNCHING OF THE INDAW KATHA OPERATION? ALSO THERE IS THE PROSPECT OF B-29 BOMBING OF RAILROAD AND PORT BANGKOK.

IF NOT, WOULD YOU PREFER TO HAVE THE INDAW KATHA OPERATION DELAYED UNTIL NOVEMBER TO INCLUDE HEAVY AMPHIBIOUS OPERATION. MEANWHILE CONCENTRATING ALL AIR TRANSPORT ON CARRYING SUPPLIES OVER THE HUMP TO AIR AND GROUND FORCES IN CHINA.

I AM INFLUENCED IN THIS MATTER BY THE TREMENDOUS ADVANTAGE TO BE RECEIVED BY CHINA AND THE PACIFIC THROUGH THE EARLY TERMINATION OF THE WAR WITH GERMANY.

ROOSEVELT